

Worksheet for Christiane Gruber's
"Whom Shall You Serve?"
by Fareen Momen
(to be used with video linked here)

Key Takeaways:

1. How does Eugene Majied use contrasting visual elements in the diptych "Whom Shall You Serve?" to represent the ideas of salvation and damnation?

2. What social and religious tensions from 1960s America does this artwork reflect, particularly in its depiction of Christianity and Islam?

3. Why might Majied have depicted the burning cross and "White Man's Slavery" church on one side, and the mosque with "God's Freedom" and the crescent moon on the other? What do these symbols communicate about the Nation of Islam's worldview or stance?

4. This talk describes the artwork as a “speech act” in visual form. What does this mean, and how can visual art, like this diptych, function as a form of political or religious argument?

Contextualizing the Work

Can you think of another historical or contemporary movement that has used visual art to draw a sharp “either-or” choice between two opposing values or identities? Explore that example’s motifs and explain how it compares to the Nation of Islam’s “Whom Shall You Serve?”